

Session 4 Final Pitch & Career Preparation



Get everything showcase-ready, then pitch.

Part	Topic	Time
01	Polish the pitch deck	6 min
02	Document your project so anyone could rebuild it	8 min
03	Make a 60–90 second demo video for your portfolio	8 min
04	The final showcase: run of show and what panels look for	8 min

Seven words you will hear today.

Word	Plain meaning
Documentation	Writing that explains what your project is, how it works and how to rebuild it.
README	The first document someone reads about a project.
Storyboard	A plan of a video, shot by shot, before you film.
Screen recording	A video of your screen, e.g. the Serial Monitor while the demo runs.
Showcase	The final event: your live pitch and demo for a panel.
Panel	The judges — here, instructors and industry guests.
Code freeze	The tested version is final; no changes before the event.

Check the car before the road trip.

Tyres, fuel, lights — before you leave, not on the motorway.

Polish the deck now, while there's time to fix things.

Eight checks.

Check	Question
Story	Problem → Solution → Technology → Impact, user as the hero?
One idea each	Can you say each slide's point in one sentence?
Readable	Can the back row read every word?
Real numbers	Every number measured or collected? Any [] left?
Consistent	Same fonts, colours and titles throughout?
Demo slide	“Live demo”, with a backup right after it?
Spelling	Has someone else read every slide?
Timing	Does a full run-through fit in 5 minutes?

A README is a recipe for your project.

A dish you can't write down is a dish only you can cook.

What it makes, the ingredients, the steps, and how to tell it worked.

A README for an INCIPE project.

Section	What to write
Title + one sentence	“Smart Garden — a pot that waters itself only when the soil is dry.”
Photo	Your real build, modules labelled
The problem	Problem statement, HMW, who it’s for
Parts list	The INCIPE modules, linked to their Wiki pages
How it works	Block diagram, flowchart, plain words
How to run it	Plug in, open in INCIPE Workspace, upload; what the Serial Monitor shows
Calibration	DRY_VALUE, WET_VALUE, START, STOP — and how to find new ones
Tests · AI · Next	The M3 Session 10 test plan filled in; AI did/checked/changed; known limits

A demo video is a film trailer.

It shows the best moments, so people want to see more — 60 to 90 seconds, no more.

It is also the backup for your live demo.

Storyboard it before you film.

Shot	Time	Show
1. Hook	5 s	The problem in one picture — a dry, drooping plant.
2. Problem	10 s	Who has it and why it matters, as a caption or voice-over.
3. Demo	30–45 s	The main path: dry soil → PUMP ON on the Serial Monitor → water flows (or the stand-in appears).
4. How it works	15 s	Your block diagram while you explain in one or two sentences.
5. Close	5 s	Project name, your name, where to find the code.

Five filming tips.

Do	Why
Landscape, phone propped up	Steady, wide shots look professional.
Light from the front	Otherwise your build is a dark shape.
Screen-record the Serial Monitor	Viewers can read it; phone shots of screens blur.
Quiet room, or captions	Many people watch without sound.
Cut every pause and mistake	Short is strong.

Check every frame for private details.

No full file paths with your name, no email addresses, no passwords or keys in a screen recording — crop or blur them.

Ask before you film classmates, and don't show anyone who hasn't agreed.

The run of show.

When	Do
Day before	Code freeze: upload the final tested sketch. Charge everything. Rehearse twice.
Day before	Backup video on the slide after “Live demo”. Check the deck opens on the showcase computer.
On the day, early	Set up, open the Serial Monitor, check every sensor gives a real value — not -1.
Just before	Prepare the start state: dry soil, cup of water, cloth. Breathe out slowly.
During	Pitch, demo the main path, take questions — “I don’t know yet” rather than invent.
After	Write down every question the panel asked — interview practice for Session 6.

What a panel often looks for.

Area	A strong project shows...
Problem	A real user and a clear, evidenced problem
Solution	A working demo of the main path, with a backup
Technology	That you understand your own system — and can explain it simply
Testing	A test plan with real results, including an unplugged sensor
Presentation	A clear story, readable slides, confident delivery
Honesty	What the AI did and what you did, said plainly

Your instructors may give their own rubric — use theirs if they do. Everything you made goes into your portfolio (Session 5), interview prep (Session 6) and CV (Session 7).

Checkpoint 1

Your deck still says “[3] of [5] students”, brackets and all. What do you do?

READ THE CODE

```
“[3] of [5] students we  
interviewed lose a plant  
every term.”
```

ANSWER

Real or remove

WHY

Replace it with your real interview numbers — or remove the claim. Never present a placeholder.

Your README has no “How to run it”. Who is stuck?

READ THE CODE

README

Title Photo Problem

Parts How it works

(no How to run it)

ANSWER

Rebuilders

WHY

Anyone who tries to rebuild or test it — a judge, a future employer. Add the steps.

Checkpoint 3

Name two things that must not be visible in a published screen recording.

READ THE CODE

```
/Users/[your name]/...  
you@example.com  
password: *****
```

ANSWER

Paths, emails

WHY

Any two of: a full file path with your name, an email address, a password, a key or token.

Checkpoint 4

The morning of the showcase you think of a small improvement. Upload it?

READ THE CODE

```
// a better threshold?
```

ANSWER

No — freeze

WHY

Present the version you tested; mention the improvement as “what’s next”.

Checkpoint 5

A judge unplugs the soil probe while the pump is off. What should happen?

READ THE CODE

```
raw = -1  
wet = 100
```

ANSWER

Nothing

WHY

A -1 reading counts as 100 % wet, so nothing switches on — your fail-safe from M3 Session 8.

Three things to take away.

1

Polish like a pre-trip check: story, one idea per slide, real numbers only, a demo slide with a backup, a timed run-through.

2

Document like a recipe and cut a 60–90 second demo video — checking every frame for private details.

3

Freeze the code the day before, check every sensor on the day, and keep the panel's questions for your career prep.

Next — Session 5: Portfolio & project showcase. Turning your projects into a portfolio: schematics, code, UI, demo videos and descriptions.